

Nicholas Mac Gregor Garcia

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English (native) · Portuguese (intermediate) · Mandarin (basic conversational; studied to intermediate level at university)

I study how China and the United States govern AI, using computational methods on primary policy texts. With Chun-Yi Peng (CUNY), I am analysing China's AI governance discourse with LexRiver, a bilingual discourse-analysis tool I built that checks every model-written interpretation against its source passages. At the National University of Singapore I teach Smart Systems and AI Governance, co-lead the NUS FinTech Lab, and convene multi-stakeholder AI policy programmes with Google and Asia-Pacific universities. I am active in Singapore's AI safety community. PhD in Information Systems, New York University (Stern).

CURRENT RESEARCH: AI GOVERNANCE IN CHINA AND THE UNITED STATES

- **Governing innovation: A computational analysis of China's AI governance discourse** (with C.-Y. Peng, CUNY; working paper). Lexical-network analysis of the 2025 *Global AI Governance Action Plan*, CAC, MIIT and MOST policy texts, and state media, tracing how its themes change from 2017 to 2025.
- **LexRiver** (2026), the research tool behind this study. It groups Chinese and English policy passages into themes, traces how the themes move between documents over time, and links each model-written reading to the passages that support it, so a reviewer can check every claim. Live read-only demo available to reviewers.
- **Comparative US–China AI policy**: how the two governments frame safety, innovation and international coordination.
- **FairEval: Evaluating LLMs in financial regulation** (with A. Chow; working paper, target *MIS Quarterly*).

EXPERIENCE

Lecturer (Educator Track), Department of Information Systems and Analytics, School of Computing, National University of Singapore Nov 2022 – present

- Teach IS4246 Smart Systems and AI Governance, IS4228 Information Technologies in Financial Services, and IS4302 Blockchain and Distributed Ledger Technologies.
- Built course material on privacy, responsible AI and model risk, mapped to Singapore's PDPA, the MAS FEAT principles, the OECD AI Principles and the EU AI Act.
- Lead research on AI governance, LLM evaluation for regulatory use, and decentralised systems, with collaborators including MAS, Google.org, PwC and Data.org.
- Supervised and mentored 30+ students; placements include MAS, Visa, KPMG and Coinbase.

Deputy Director; Co-Director (Industry), NUS FinTech Lab Nov 2022 – present

- Lead the lab's external engagement and partnerships with industry and public-sector stakeholders, including Ripple, Coinbase and Mastercard.
- Helped secure and renew over SGD 1 million in funding from partners including Google.org, Ripple and Data.org.
- Organised the NUS FinTech Lab Crawl (2023, 2024), an ecosystem event with 500+ attendees; gave the opening remarks and partner briefings.
- Delivered executive briefings on AI evaluation and governance to corporate partners and public-sector agencies.
- Oversee the lab's industry reports, podcast series, internal research projects and incubation of student ventures.

Lead Academic Organiser, Judge and Advisor, APRU Asia-Pacific Tech Policy Hackathon 2024 – present

- Co-direct a flagship multi-country programme that brings policy experts, technologists, business leaders and students from Google and Asia-Pacific universities together to design AI governance, data-policy and economic-resilience proposals.
- Ran mentor and judge onboarding, evaluation design and end-to-end operations; coached multi-university teams on AI governance, digital inclusion and financial innovation.

AI safety education, Singapore AI Safety Hub (SASH) and Odysea AI 2025 – present

- Facilitator, AI Safety Teaching Collab at SASH: led weekly sessions on AI governance and alignment in a peer-led course built on syllabi by researchers at Harvard, Oxford, Cambridge and OpenAI.
- Advisor, Odysea AI safety course (odysea-ai.org).

- Advise on AI and blockchain strategy, regulatory context, positioning and partnerships; facilitate senior sessions on AI risk management.

Earlier teaching: Co-Instructor, Data Analytics for Business, New York University (2020); Instructor, AI ethics and machine learning workshops, Inspirit AI (2021)

PUBLICATIONS

- Tham, L., Garcia, N. M. G., & Hahn, J. (2026). Internal APIs are all you need: Shadow APIs, shared discovery, and the case against browser-first agent architectures. *arXiv:2604.00694*.
- See, K., Garcia, N., & Li, X. (2025). Simulating blockchain applications in large-value payment systems through agent-based modeling. *AAMAS 2025*.
- Garcia, N., See, K., & Shobri, H. (2024). PSSimPy: A design science approach to constructing and implementing a large-value payment system simulator. *ICIS 2024*.
- Peng, C.-Y., & Garcia, N. (2020). Mediatized Taiwanese Mandarin: A text-mining approach to speaker stereotypes. *Open Linguistics*, 6(1), 611–625. <https://doi.org/10.1515/opli-2020-0035>
- Garcia, N. "Rule of code" or "rule of man"? How assumptions of human nature impact the design of blockchain-based algorithmic management systems. Doctoral dissertation, New York University.
- Policy research: AI for ASEAN Development, FCDO-funded research on AI governance in climate, education and health policy.

SELECTED POLICY WRITING

Essays for policy and executive readers at nicholasg3.github.io, including:

- Who Is Accountable When AI Acts · When AI Disclosure Is Due · What an AI Disclosure Record Must Contain
- What Agents Are Allowed To Do · AI-Written Research Needs Verification Records More Than a Separate Venue

TALKS AND CONVENINGS

- Speaker, Ethereum Research Forum, ArtScience Museum, Singapore (Sept 2025): blockchain governance and financial systems.
- Panellist and moderator, UNICON 2023, NUS Entrepreneurship Society (600+ participants from 20+ countries).
- Ripple UBRI Connect 2024 (cross-domain risk in arbitrage); DiO Conference 2023 (algorithmic governance); Academy of Management 2020 (ideology in algorithmic governance).

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems , New York University, Stern School of Business	2022
Master of Information Systems Management , Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College	2015
BS, Chemical Engineering , University of California, Berkeley	2012

SERVICE AND SKILLS

- Reviewer, International Conference on Information Systems (2018 – present); member, Academy of Management.
- Institutional liaison, APRU–NUS FinTech collaboration; academic advisor, NUS Digital Transformation Leadership Programme (2026).
- LLM benchmarking, explainable AI, multi-agent simulation; Python.